

NYLON A trade name for a range of synthetic fibres used to make a wide variety of garments, notably stockings and tights; see also *Paper nylon*.

1935 ▷

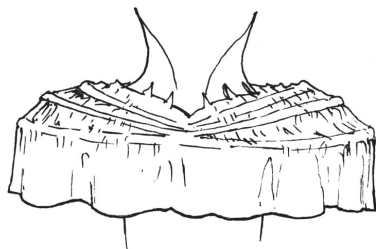


OBİ A long sash worn around the waist, over a *kimono*, as part of traditional Japanese dress; women wear a wide obi, which can be tied in a variety of decorative knots.

SEE P.459

OBLONG HOOPS Whalebone or willow structures that evolved from *panniers*, forming a wide, flat shape to support the *robe à la française*.

1740s–1760s



OFF-THE-PEG A term for a garment of a standard shape and size that is not customized for the wearer; see *Ready-to-wear*.

OPEN GOWN A style of women's dress in which the overskirt is open at the front to reveal a decorative underskirt or *petticoat*; see also *Mantua*.

18TH CENTURY ▷: SEE PP.87, 142–3

OPERA HAT A man's formal hat that could be compressed and easily carried under the arm; one form, the *gibus hat*, is still used today.

19TH CENTURY ▷

ORGANDIE A fine cotton or nylon gauze with a crisp finish.

19TH CENTURY ▷

ORGANZA A light, crisp, sheer fabric of silk, polyester, or rayon.

EARLY 19TH CENTURY ▷

ORIENTALISM The adoption of Middle Eastern and Far Eastern traditional dress styles, or interpretations of these styles, in European or American fashion.

17TH CENTURY ▷: SEE PP.188–91, 212–3, 244–5, 267

ORPHREY A form of embroidery using gold thread.

13TH CENTURY ▷

OXFORD BAGS Very wide, baggy trousers for men, particularly associated with students at Oxford University, UK; revived for both sexes in the 1970s; see also *Plus fours*.

1920s AND 1970s

OXFORD SHIRTING A plain weave cotton with narrow, coloured stripes.

19TH CENTURY



PADDOCK COAT A knee-length, single-breasted or double-breasted overcoat for men, with two inverted box pleats at the rear.

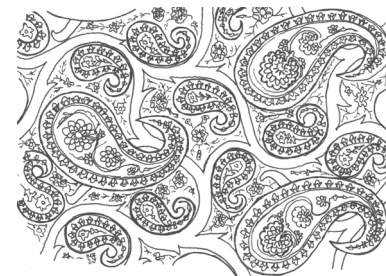
1892 ▷

PAGODA SLEEVES Elbow-length, bell-shaped sleeves on dresses, with *engageantes* worn under them.

1849–1860s: SEE PP.196–7

PAISLEY PATTERN A distinctive teardrop-shaped motif adapted from Indian buteh patterns, named for the Scottish town that wove imitation Kashmiri shawls; also featured on *Liberty prints*.

19TH CENTURY ▷: SEE PP.366, 377



PALAZZO PANTS Loose, wide-legged trousers for women, often in a light, soft fabric.

1960s ▷: SEE P.451

PALETOT (a) A three-quarter-length pleated cloak with a stiff cape, for women, or a close-fitting, knee-length outdoor coat; (b) a short greatcoat, worn by men.

19TH CENTURY: SEE P.216

PALLA A rectangular wrap draped around the body, worn by women.

ANCIENT ROME

PANAMA HAT A man's summer hat woven from fibres of the Central American toquilla palm, and flexible enough to be rolled up for carrying.

1830s ▷

PANES A decoration on sleeves or men's trunk hose, made by slashing the fabric so that the lining or undergarments showed through.

1500–c.1660: SEE PP.88–93



PANNE VELVET Soft velvet with the pile pressed flat in one direction to give a highly lustrous surface.

LATE 18TH CENTURY ▷

PANNIERS Also known as side hoops, these were pads or frames attached to the hips to hold the skirt out at the sides; they evolved into large oblong hoops.

EARLY 18TH CENTURY: SEE PP.146, 149

PANTOFLES Slip-on overshoes for outdoor wear, or slippers for indoors.

LATE 15TH–MID-17TH CENTURY: SEE P.84

PAPER NYLON A stiff, paper-like form of nylon, notably used to make the layers of *petticoats* under 1950s skirts.

1950s ▷

PARDESSUS Mid-length overcoat for women, with a shaped waist, and often trimmed with velvet or fur.

1840s ▷

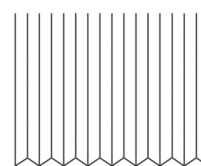
PAREO A traditional Tahitian wrap for women, originally made from bark cloth and tied around the waist; modern pareos are made of cotton and are popular as beachwear.

PARKA A coat worn by the Arctic peoples of North America; today a warm, protective, waterproof garment often made of synthetic material, with a fur-lined hood; see also *Anorak*, *Mod style*.

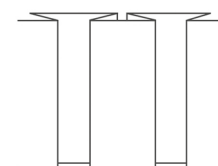
1960s ▷: SEE P.346



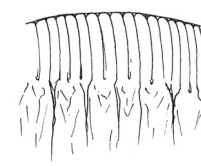
PLEATS



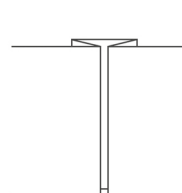
ACCORDION PLEATS



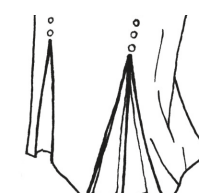
BOX PLEATS



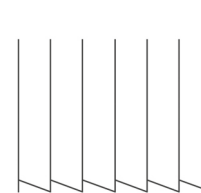
CARTRIDGE PLEATS



INVERTED PLEATS



KICK PLEATS



KNIFE PLEATS